

I'm getting scared. Have we ever had a technology as new and advanced as AI become so widespread and then become obsolete due to public criticism and environmental damage before?

Posted by u/dmso_disgusting • 0 points • 22 comments

I'm getting worried that we're "past the point of no return" and that there is simply no way for AI to be removed from society. For every person like us here that hates AI for any number of reasons there is another person who loves AI because it makes their life easier. The corporations are so powerful too. By the time the protests of the people hurt their bottom lines I fear we'll be too far gone as a species. That brings me to my question: has there ever been a technological advancement that has been drastically scaled back due solely to public criticism and environmental damage? I want to believe that we can make a difference but I am quickly losing hope.

Comments

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2026-02-09 22:29 UTC

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u/Similar_Low_7881 • 1 points • 2026-02-08 04:53 UTC

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u/dumnezzero • 1 points • 2026-02-07 19:46 UTC

>due to

correlation doesn't mean causation.

u/mariposa333 • 2 points • 2026-02-07 13:24 UTC

I am not so sure... I think it goes hand in hand with the world-wide drop in literacy and the subsequent damage to critical thinking and reasoning. People are so easily fooled/mislead because they lack the ability to quite literally put 2 and 2 together. I just saw a great piece on AI Jazeera that explained literacy is so much more than just "reading", it's three steps; recognize ideas in a sentence, connect multiple ideas throughout a text, and finally relate those ideas to our own lived experience. *About half of

American adults for example cannot get past step one** Even if AI actually does not make someone's life easier, chances are they very well may not have the critical thinking skills to understand that.

u/Virtually_Harmless • 1 points • 2026-02-07 09:56 UTC

you should be scared. we're all doomed

u/Nice_Specific_8706 • 1 points • 2026-02-07 15:36 UTC

doomed because people know they're doomed, but continues to engage with the exact factor is that is causing the doom.

u/Virtually_Harmless • 1 points • 2026-02-07 17:35 UTC

Reddit?

u/AggravatingUnion6468 • 2 points • 2026-02-07 08:55 UTC

Cars with Nuclear reactors never became a reality due to nuclear fender benders.
I hope AI goes the way of the Ford Nucleon.

u/Alward73 • 2 points • 2026-02-07 09:14 UTC

I didn't know this: that's fully mad! 😂

Why does it have a roulette wheel on the front too?

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[width=1500&format=png&auto=webp&s=d94c51acb25a1c73659da8c23914ea5d00be4dff](https://preview.redd.it/lygggc3nh1ig1.png?width=1500&format=png&auto=webp&s=d94c51acb25a1c73659da8c23914ea5d00be4dff)

u/Dickie_downer • 2 points • 2026-02-07 08:41 UTC

Teflon was widespread then they discovered it basically poisoned everything, so now everyone has teflon in them.

People still use it but general unease cause people to steer clear nowadays

u/7grims • 1 points • 2026-02-07 08:40 UTC

It will end soon-ish, but its not gonna be fun, the AI bubble will burst and create the worst economic crash ever, with all the multiple trillions that was lend to each of these companies... its gonna be ugly.

I guess afterwards we will still have AI, but scaled down to the few companies not rushing nor investing so heavily as now.

u/Ok-Society483 • 1 points • 2026-02-07 21:37 UTC

Oh it's going to be worse, they will still invest only in private and while their pet project slowly gets .01 complete they will use the fall to get pity from the government who will bail them out while still finding ways to not pay people right.

u/7grims • 1 points • 2026-02-07 23:03 UTC

in both cases they will get bail out money, hence a economic recession

but ur saying it will be a continuous bail out endeavour ? if i got it right

u/Ok-Society483 • 2 points • 2026-02-09 19:48 UTC

Oh my fault, no I meant companies will just keep spending on AI, just not as much. Then will act pitiful so the gov't will give them money

u/AggravatingUnion6468 • 2 points • 2026-02-07 08:55 UTC

I guess that is the best we can hope for now.

u/7grims • 2 points • 2026-02-07 09:48 UTC

hopefully soon, the more years this last the dept just gonna get bigger :/

u/Alward73 • 4 points • 2026-02-07 08:33 UTC

Nuclear energy I think was initially popular as a way to produce more power than people would ever need, but then became unpopular due to safety / cost / disposal concerns.

u/FlashyNeedleworker66 • 2 points • 2026-02-07 12:58 UTC

A tenth of global power generation is nuclear, it didn't go away

u/DAemonCayuse • 4 points • 2026-02-07 09:57 UTC

The idea of Nuclear power has been ran through by big oil. It's actually safer, cheaper, and, much better for the environment.

u/Alward73 • 3 points • 2026-02-07 10:07 UTC

I've heard that said and it wouldn't surprise me. I think the nightmarishness of nuclear accidents like Chernobyl doesn't help the perception much either though.

u/DAemonCayuse • 2 points • 2026-02-07 10:09 UTC

Yeah, that's bad for the narrative for sure. Hey, maybe it was staged by exxon or something

u/Mobile-Shower6651 • 3 points • 2026-02-07 08:33 UTC

what's worse is when you read about other news

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[width=1091&format=pjpg&auto=webp&s=6fb19e297825bdf2b5d6678614ebc27fc5b2f48b](https://preview.redd.it/32x1cxfea1ig1.jpeg?width=1091&format=pjpg&auto=webp&s=6fb19e297825bdf2b5d6678614ebc27fc5b2f48b)

u/Alward73 • 1 points • 2026-02-07 09:16 UTC

What happened! We've gone from "this is our last chance to stop climate crisis" to "drill, baby, drill."

Could not be handling it any worse.

u/Mobile-Shower6651 • 2 points • 2026-02-10 06:23 UTC

not only that but:

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u/Mobile-Shower6651 • 2 points • 2026-02-07 08:38 UTC

we making history boys

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